

Govt. Graduate College for Women, Baghbanpura, Lahore
BS Psychology 3rd semester

Topic 1

Introduction of Philosophy

Short Questions

1. Define Philosophy

Ans. The word Philosophy is derived from two Greek words *Philia* and *Sophia*. *Philia* means Love and *Sophia* means Wisdom. So philosophy can be defined as Love for Wisdom. Philosophy is a subject that is related to every aspect of human life whether it be material or non material.

2. Describe the process of philosophy

Ans. In Philosophy we use reason to gather knowledge about things through two processes which are Analysis and Synthesis. Through analysis we divide a problem into its constituent parts and discuss them separately. In synthesis the parts of problem are merged to get a holistic view of it.

3. Why is Philosophy considered mother of all knowledge?

Ans. Philosophy is named as mother of all knowledge by August Comte because the endeavour of human knowledge and understanding began with Philosophy. In the beginning all subjects were a part of philosophy. As man progressed his knowledge about different aspects of universe increased and so different subjects such as sciences, arts, civics and psychology etc separated from Philosophy.

4. What are the highlights of philosophy of ancient era?

Ans. The Ancient era philosophy includes Greek Philosophy, Hindu Philosophy, Persian Philosophy etc. These philosophies were geographically bound and their scope was metaphysics and explanation of universe. Plato, Aristotle, Socrates, Pythagoras are a few famous names of this era.

5. What are the Highlights of medieval philosophy?

Ans. The Medieval philosophy includes Christian philosophy and Muslim Philosophy. The main topic of discussion in this era of philosophy was God, Man and the relationship of these three with each other. The

prominent philosophers of this era are Alfarabi, Ibn Sina, Imam Ghazali etc.

6. What are the highlights of modern philosophy?

Ans. Modern philosophy includes topics such as philosophy of mind, moral views, politics, linguistics, mathematical and symbolic logic, positivism, existentialism, modern philosophy of science and postmodernism. Some prominent philosophers of this era are Descartes, Locke, Kant, Hegel, Marx etc.

7. Define Metaphysics.

Ans. Metaphysics is the study of reality and existence. It studies what we are and what our purpose is. It deals with the first principles of things, including abstract concepts such as being, knowing, identity, time, and space. Aristotle formally explored fundamental questions of metaphysics with topics about being, first causes, and change.

8. Define Epistemology.

Ans. Epistemology is the branch of philosophy that is concerned with knowledge. In Epistemology we study the nature, origin, and scope of knowledge, epistemic justification, the rationality of belief, and various related issues. Epistemology has always been divided into two distinct trends known as Rationalism and Empiricism.

9. What is the definition of Aesthetics?

Ans. Aesthetics is the philosophical study of beauty and taste. It is closely related to the philosophy of art, which is concerned with the nature of art and the concepts in terms of which individual works of art are interpreted and evaluated.

10. What is meant by morality?

Ans. Ethics or morality is a branch of philosophy where value of human actions are determined according to different criteria. It investigates normative questions about what people ought to do or which behavior is morally right. The main branches of ethics include normative ethics, applied ethics, and meta ethics.

11. How Ontology explains the origin of universe?

Ans. Ontology is a branch of philosophy that raises questions about the nature and origin of universe. It talks about substance and space,

universal intellect and nature as possible solution to the problem of explanation of how the universe came into being. Its main aspects are
Monism: substance behind creation is one i.e; God, Nous, Nature
Dualism: Substance behind creation are two i.e; Mind and Body
Pluralism: Substances behind creation are not one or two rather many i.e; atoms, four elements(earth, fire, water, air)

12. What is the value of philosophy in modern world?

Ans. Philosophy can help people to understand themselves and their place in the world. One of the main benefits of studying philosophy is that it can teach us how to question our assumptions and beliefs. Many of us take certain things for granted, without ever really questioning why we believe them.

Some important aspects that maintain the relevance of philosophy in the modern world is that philosophy teaches us critical thinking, instead of blindly following in idea we never forget to question its credibility. Philosophy can also help people understand themselves. Because of these and many other aspects philosophy is an integral part of philosophy.

13. Define Analytic philosophy

Ans. Analytic philosophy is a movement of contemporary philosophy that developed around 20th century. The movement started as a reaction against British Idealism. The aim of the movement was to bring clarity and objectivity in philosophical arguments. Its main branches are Logic, Empiricism, Language, Science etc. Russell, Wittgenstein, Frege are a few prominent philosophers of this movement

13. Define Continental philosophy

Ans. Continental Philosophy was a philosophical trend of the 19th and 20th century and was concentrated in the Germany and France. It focuses on a vast variety of topics such as literature, humanities, existence, human situation on earth, politics and cultural issues etc. Its main concern is synthesis; of modernity with history, individual with society etc. Some prominent philosophers of this branch are Nietzsche, Marx, Hegel etc.

B. Long Questions.

1. Define philosophy. Describe its nature and scope.

Ans. Philosophy literally means '**love of wisdom**'. It is an attempt to arrive at a rational conception of the reality as a whole. It enquires into the nature of the universe in which we live, the nature of the human soul, and its destiny, and the nature of God or the Absolute, and their relation to one another.

It enquires into the nature of matter, time, space, causality, evolution, life, and mind, and their relation to one another. It is the art of thinking all things logically, systematically, and persistently. It is the art of thinking rationally and systematically of the reality as a whole.

Plato rightly conceived of philosophy as the persistent attempt to seek clear notions. It examines, clarifies, and explains popular and scientific concepts of matter, space, time, causality, evolution, mechanism, teleology, life, mind or soul, God or the Absolute, right and wrong, good and evil, beauty and ugliness, and the like, and arrives at a rational conception of the reality. Clarification of concepts is the task of philosophy.

It systematizes our scientific knowledge, and moral, aesthetic and religious experiences. It analyses the popular and scientific concepts, examines their validity in the light of reason, and interrelates them to one another. Its method is logical and rational. Its chief instrument is logic. Its method is rational speculation—logical analysis and synthesis.

Philosophy consists of three parts:

- (1) Epistemology;
- (2) Ontology and Metaphysics, and
- (3) Axiology.

Epistemology is the theory of Knowledge. Ontology or Metaphysics is the theory of Being or Reality. Axiology is the theory of Values. Modern philosophy is not dogmatic. It does not plunge into metaphysical investigation of the nature of reality without a prior criticism of the organ of knowledge. It is based on epistemology. Epistemology enquires into the nature, origin, validity and extent of knowledge.

Ontology or Metaphysics is the theory of Being. It enquires into the nature of the reality. It investigates the nature of the world including matter and life, of the soul, and of God or the Absolute.

Axiology is all about the values that we need and must establish for a balanced and efficient working of a society. These values include standards of valid language and thought, standards of moral judgements and standards of valid language and thought.

2. How can Analytic and Continental philosophical trends compared?

Ans. Analytic philosophy and Continental philosophy are two distinct philosophical traditions that developed in the 20th century. Although a modern movement its roots go way back in Greek era of Philosophy. One thinks of Pythagoras, Archimedes or of course of Aristotle, who had laid the foundations for the binary logic and with it the ultimate criteria for the distinctions into "true" and "false" statements.

Analytic philosophy is characterized by a focus on clarity, precision, and argumentation in philosophical inquiry. It is typically associated with philosophers from the English-speaking world and is known for its focus on logical analysis and the use of formal methods such as formal logic and the linguistic analysis of language. Key figures in analytic philosophy include Bertrand Russell, Ludwig Wittgenstein, and G.E. Moore.

Continental philosophy, on the other hand, tends to emphasize interpretation, meaning, and the broader cultural and historical context of philosophical inquiry. It originated in Europe and is associated with a more existential approach, taking into account questions about existence, meaning, and subjectivity. Key figures in continental philosophy include Friedrich Nietzsche, Martin Heidegger, and Jean-Paul Sartre.

In summary, the difference between analytic and continental philosophy can be seen in their approaches and priorities in philosophical inquiry, with analytic philosophy focusing on clarity and precision, while continental philosophy emphasizes interpretation and the cultural context.